- Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity
- Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority
- Efficiency vs Process
  tags:
- annotation
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- topic-automation
- tension-operational-assistance-v-epistemic-authority
- tension-efficiency-v-process
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, EASST/4S)

Zeffiro, A. (McMaster University) Automating (in)securities: cybersecurity's AI imaginaries (2024)

Stable link:

🔗 https://nomadit.co.uk/conference/easst-4s2024/p/14156 (https://nomadit.co.uk/conference/easst-4s2024/p/14156)

Annotation

Zeffiro interrogates cybersecurity's AI imaginaries through case studies of IBM Watson for Cybersecurity, CrowdStrike's Charlotte AI, and Google's Sec-PaLM, revealing how corporate narratives of AI as "game changer" and "democratizing force" systematically obscure differential vulnerabilities and normative biases. Her analysis challenges the prevalent framing of AI-driven threat detection as technically neutral automation, arguing instead that these systems encode and amplify assumptions about what constitutes risk, who merits protection, and whose insecurities remain invisible. Drawing on critical security studies and science and technology studies, Zeffiro demonstrates how generative AI applications in cybersecurity automate not merely data collection and pattern recognition but also the normative s about threat hierarchies embedded in training regimes and performance metrics. Her concept of "automating insecurities" captures this dual process: while AI tools promise enhanced security through real-time threat response with minimal human intervention, they simultaneously institutionalize particular understandings of vulnerability that reflect corporate priorities and market positioning in the "AI arms race." Zeffiro's analysis connects these imaginaries to epistemic claims about AI's inevitability, showing how IBM, CrowdStrike, and Google construct future visions that naturalize their technological approaches while marginalizing alternative security paradigms. By foregrounding what these imaginaries omit—the differential distribution of cyber vulnerabilities across social positions, the political economy of security infrastructure, the discretionary authority embedded in algorithmic triage—Zeffiro positions cybersecurity AI as participating in broader patterns of automation that redistribute power and accountability rather than merely enhancing technical capabilities.

📖 Appears in Introduction

This annotation is cited in the following sections of the analytical introduction:

- [[Analytical Introduction]] — Critical Literacies

Navigate to [[Analytical Introduction]] for the complete overview.

Connections

Domain: [[Essential Contexts]] → Histories & Theories of AI

Tensions: [[Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity]] · [[Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority]] · [[Efficiency vs Process]]

Key Concepts: [[Automation]] · [[Infrastructure]] · [[Epistemic Authority]] · [[Generative Ai]] · [[Accountability]] · [[Bias]] · [[Participation]] · [[Evaluation]]

Methodologies: `case study`, `computational`

Stakeholders: institutions, industry

Return to: [[Taking Bearings - Home]] | [[Essential Contexts]] | [[Concepts Glossary]]

📎 Related Notes (3)
- [[Richter 2025 - Imaginaries-of-Artificial-Intelligence]] — *content similarity (0.26) | shared concepts: automation, evaluation, accountability | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Efficiency vs Process* - [[Ma 2024 - Generative-AI-for-Academic-Publishing-S]] — *shared concepts: generative AI, automation, infrastructure, epistemic authority | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Efficiency vs Process, Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority | shared methodology: case study* - [[Mai 2024 - The-Use-of-ChatGPT-in-Teaching-and-Learn]] — *shared concepts: generative AI, automation, evaluation, accountability | shared tension: Technical Capability vs Organizational Capacity, Efficiency vs Process, Operational Assistance vs Epistemic Authority | shared methodology: case study*